

NGO Registration Checklist — Bangladesh (Blu Foundation)

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CRITICAL DISCLAIMER — READ BEFORE PROCEEDING

*This checklist is a general operational guide based on publicly available information about Bangladesh NGO registration requirements as of June 2026. Laws, regulations, fees, processing times, and procedural requirements are subject to change without notice. **This document does not constitute legal advice.** Before filing any documents or taking any formal steps, Blu Foundation must: (a) consult a qualified Bangladeshi lawyer experienced in NGO and company law, (b) verify all current requirements directly with the relevant government authority, and (c) confirm no regulatory changes have occurred since this document was produced. Items marked **[VERIFY]** require direct confirmation before action is taken.*

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1. Overview and Registration Pathway Recommendation

1.1 Bangladesh NGO Registration Frameworks

Bangladesh offers several legal frameworks under which a civil society or non-profit organization can be formally constituted. The three most relevant for Blu Foundation are:

Framework	Governing Law	Suitable For
Society	Societies Registration Act 1860	Membership-based non-profits; simplest route for domestic operations
NGOAB-registered Organization	Foreign Donations (Voluntary Activities) Regulation Act 2016	Any organization receiving or intending to receive foreign funds
Company Limited by Guarantee	Companies Act 1994	Larger organizations requiring corporate governance structure

1.2 Recommended Pathway for Blu Foundation

Given that Blu Foundation is an education-focused NGO at the formation stage, the recommended standard pathway is a **two-step process**:

Step 1 — Society Registration Register as a Society under the **Societies Registration Act 1860** with the Registrar of Joint Stock Companies and Firms (RJSC). This establishes the legal entity.

Step 2 — NGOAB Registration (*conditional — see flag below*) Register with the **NGO Affairs Bureau (NGOAB)** under the **Foreign Donations (Voluntary Activities) Regulation Act 2016**. This step is required only if Blu Foundation intends to receive any foreign donations, grants, or funding from international sources.

Domestic-only funding: If Blu Foundation will operate exclusively on domestic Bangladeshi funding (local donations, government grants, Bangladeshi corporate CSR), Society registration alone under the Societies Registration Act 1860 is sufficient for initial operations.

Alternative pathway: Registration as a company limited by guarantee under the **Companies Act 1994** provides a more structured corporate governance framework and may be preferable if Blu Foundation anticipates significant scale, formal board accountability requirements, or engagement with institutional funders who prefer a company structure. This route is more complex and costly at the outset but provides structural advantages at scale. [VERIFY SUITABILITY WITH LEGAL COUNSEL]

1.3 Founder Input Required

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] Will Blu Foundation seek foreign donations, grants, or funding from international organizations (e.g., UN agencies, foreign government aid programs, international foundations, overseas diaspora donations)? This is the single most important determinant of whether NGOAB registration is required.

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] Is the founding principal a Bangladeshi citizen? Foreign nationals founding or directing an NGO in Bangladesh are subject to additional approval requirements from the Ministry of Home Affairs and NGOAB. This materially affects the registration timeline and process.

2. Pre-Registration Checklist

Complete all items in this checklist before beginning any formal filing. Incomplete preparation is the most common cause of delays.

2.1 Organizational Identity

- ☐ **Choose the organization name** — Confirm "Blu Foundation" or a full Bangladeshi legal name variant is available and not already registered with RJSC. The name must be unique.
 - Action: Search RJSC records to confirm name availability [VERIFY search method with RJSC directly or via legal counsel]
 - The official name on registration documents must be used consistently across all subsequent filings
- ☐ **Finalize the Mission Statement** — A concise written statement of what Blu Foundation does and why (one to three sentences). This will appear in the Memorandum of Association.
- ☐ **Finalize the Vision Statement** — A forward-looking statement of the long-term change Blu Foundation seeks to achieve.
- ☐ **Confirm the stated objects of the society** — These are the specific purposes for which the organization is formed, as listed in the Memorandum of Association. For Blu Foundation: manners and etiquette education for primary school children in Bangladesh. The objects clause must be drafted carefully — it determines what the organization is legally permitted to do.

2.2 Founding Members

- ☐ **Identify a minimum of 7 founding members** — Society registration under the Societies Registration Act 1860 requires a minimum of 7 founding members (natural persons).
 - All 7 must be willing to sign the founding documents
 - All must be adults with valid national identification
- ☐ **Collect from each founding member:**
 - ☐ Full legal name (as on National Identity Document)
 - ☐ Current residential address
 - ☐ Occupation
 - ☐ National Identity Document (NID) number and photocopy
 - ☐ Recent passport-size photographs (confirm number required [VERIFY WITH RJSC])
 - ☐ Signature (wet ink will be required on filed documents)

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] Provide the names and NID details of all founding board members. Minimum 7 individuals required. This information is needed to draft the founding member list and Memorandum of Association.

2.3 Registered Office

- ☐ **Identify and secure a physical registered office address in Bangladesh** — A real, physical address is required. A P.O. box is not sufficient.
- ☐ **Prepare proof of address** — This may be a rental agreement, utility bill, or property ownership document in the organization's name or an authorized name. [VERIFY acceptable proof formats with RJSC and NGOAB]

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] Provide the registered office address. This address will appear on the registration certificate and all official correspondence.

2.4 Governing Documents

- ☐ **Draft the Memorandum of Association** — covering: name of the society, registered office location, and objects of the society
- ☐ **Draft the Rules and Regulations (Constitution)** — covering at minimum:
 - Membership criteria and classes
 - Governing body (executive committee) structure, composition, and term limits
 - Election procedures for office bearers
 - Meeting frequency requirements (general body and executive committee)
 - Quorum requirements
 - Financial management procedures
 - Audit requirements
 - Amendment procedures
 - Dissolution provisions
- ☐ **Legal review of governing documents** — Have a qualified lawyer review and finalize both documents before signing or filing

2.5 Professional Support (Pre-Registration)

- ☐ Identify and engage a lawyer with NGO/society registration experience in Bangladesh
- ☐ Identify and engage a chartered accountant for compliance planning

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] Has legal counsel been identified? If not, this should be the first action taken before any other step.

3. Part A: Society Registration (Societies Registration Act 1860)

Authority: Registrar of Joint Stock Companies and Firms (RJSC) **Legal basis:** Societies Registration Act 1860

3.1 Step-by-Step Registration Process

- 1. Prepare the Memorandum of Association**
 - Include: full name of the society, address of the registered office, and a clear statement of the objects (purposes) of the society
 - Have all founding members review and approve the draft
 - Prepare 3 printed copies (confirm current copy requirement with RJSC)
- 2. Prepare the Rules and Regulations**
 - The governing document of the society (see Section 2.4 for required content)
 - Prepare 3 printed copies (confirm current copy requirement with RJSC)
- 3. Prepare the founding member list**
 - Typed list containing: full name, residential address, occupation, and signature of each founding member
 - Minimum 7 founding members required
 - All members must personally sign the list (wet ink signatures required)
- 4. Prepare all supporting documents** (see document list in Section 3.2 below)
- 5. Complete the application form**
 - Obtain the current application form from RJSC directly or through the RJSC online portal
 - [VERIFY WITH RJSC whether an online filing option is available or if in-person submission is required]
- 6. Submit the application to RJSC**
 - Submit at the RJSC office or via the applicable online portal
 - Retain proof of submission (acknowledgement receipt)
- 7. Pay the registration fee**
 - [VERIFY CURRENT FEE WITH RJSC] — fees are set by government schedule and subject to change
 - Retain the official payment receipt
- 8. Respond to any RJSC queries**
 - RJSC may request additional information, corrections, or clarifications
 - Respond promptly to avoid delays in processing
- 9. Receive the Society Registration Certificate**
 - This is the primary legal document establishing Blu Foundation as a registered entity

- Store the original securely; obtain certified copies

10. Obtain certified copies of the registration certificate

- Multiple certified copies are needed for subsequent steps (bank account, TIN, NGOAB)
- [VERIFY WITH RJSC the process and cost for obtaining certified copies]

3.2 Documents Required for Society Registration

- ☐ Completed application form (form prescribed by RJSC)
- ☐ Memorandum of Association (3 copies, signed by all founding members)
- ☐ Rules and Regulations / Constitution (3 copies, signed by all founding members)
- ☐ Founding member list (with names, addresses, occupations, and wet ink signatures)
- ☐ NID photocopies of all founding members (attested/notarized as required)
- ☐ Passport-size photographs of all founding members
- ☐ Proof of registered office address (rental agreement, utility bill, or ownership document)
- ☐ Payment receipt for registration fee

[VERIFY WITH RJSC] Confirm the current and complete document list, number of copies required, attestation/notarization requirements, and whether any documents require affidavit or commissioner of oaths certification before submission.

3.3 Timeline

Estimated processing time: **approximately 4–8 weeks** from submission of a complete application.

[VERIFY CURRENT TIMELINE WITH RJSC] Processing times vary based on RJSC workload, completeness of submission, and any queries raised. Budget additional time for responding to queries or correcting deficiencies.

3.4 Part A Completion Checklist

- ☐ Memorandum of Association drafted, reviewed by lawyer, and signed by all founding members
- ☐ Rules and Regulations drafted, reviewed by lawyer, and signed by all founding members
- ☐ Founding member list prepared and signed
- ☐ All supporting documents collected and organized
- ☐ Application form completed
- ☐ Application submitted to RJSC
- ☐ Submission receipt obtained and filed
- ☐ Registration fee paid; receipt retained
- ☐ Society Registration Certificate received

- ☐ Certified copies of Registration Certificate obtained (minimum 3–5 copies recommended)

4. Part B: NGOAB Registration (for Organizations Seeking Foreign Donations)

Authority: NGO Affairs Bureau (NGOAB), Prime Minister's Office **Legal basis:** Foreign Donations (Voluntary Activities) Regulation Act 2016

This section applies only if Blu Foundation intends to receive foreign donations or funding from foreign sources. If Blu Foundation will operate on domestic funding only, proceed directly to Section 5 (Bank Account Requirements).

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] Confirm whether NGOAB registration is required before beginning the steps in this section.

4.1 Step-by-Step NGOAB Registration Process

- 1. Obtain Society Registration Certificate** (prerequisite — must complete Part A first)
 - NGOAB registration cannot proceed without a valid Society registration certificate (or equivalent legal entity registration)
- 2. Open an organizational bank account** (prerequisite — see Section 5)
 - A bank account statement will be required for the NGOAB application
 - Complete Section 5 before proceeding to Step 4 of this section
- 3. Obtain Tax Identification Number (TIN)** (prerequisite — see Section 6)
 - TIN certificate is required for NGOAB application
 - Complete Section 6 before proceeding to Step 4 of this section
- 4. Register on the NGOAB online portal**
 - Access the NGOAB online application system
 - [VERIFY CURRENT PORTAL URL WITH NGOAB DIRECTLY — do not rely on third-party sources for this link]
 - Create an organizational account on the portal
- 5. Prepare the project proposal**
 - NGOAB registration requires a project proposal describing:
 - Planned activities (manners and etiquette education programs for primary school children)
 - Target beneficiaries and geographic areas
 - Implementation methodology

- Monitoring and evaluation approach
- Proposed budget (typically a 3-year projection)
- Funding sources (domestic and foreign)
- The proposal must be realistic, detailed, and consistent with the stated objects in the Memorandum of Association

6. Prepare a 3-year organizational budget

- Itemized income and expenditure projections
- Must account for both program and administrative costs
- Recommended: prepared or reviewed by a chartered accountant

7. Compile all required documents (see Section 4.2 below)

8. Submit the application via the NGOAB portal

- Upload all required documents in the formats specified by the portal
- Retain the application submission reference number

9. Government inspection and verification

- NGOAB will conduct a physical inspection visit to the registered office address
- Ensure the registered office is operational and accessible at the time of inspection
- Key office bearers should be available to meet the inspection team

10. Ministry of Social Welfare review and approval

- For education-focused NGOs, the primary line ministry is typically the Ministry of Social Welfare or Ministry of Primary and Mass Education
- [VERIFY WITH NGOAB which ministry provides the relevant ministerial clearance for education NGOs at the time of application]
- The ministerial approval is a required step before NGOAB issues the registration certificate

11. Receive NGOAB Registration Certificate

- This certificate must be maintained and renewed as required
- [VERIFY WITH NGOAB the current renewal period and process]

4.2 Key Documents for NGOAB Application

- ☐ Society Registration Certificate (certified copy)
- ☐ Memorandum of Association (certified copy)
- ☐ Rules and Regulations / Constitution (certified copy)
- ☐ NID copies of all founding/executive committee members

- ☐ Passport-size photographs of key office bearers
- ☐ Proof of registered office (current)
- ☐ Bank account statement (organizational account — see Section 5)
- ☐ Bank solvency certificate or account opening confirmation [VERIFY REQUIREMENT]
- ☐ Tax Identification Number (TIN) certificate
- ☐ Project proposal (current planned activities and methodology)
- ☐ 3-year organizational budget
- ☐ Audited financial statements (if the organization has been operating — not applicable at formation stage)
- ☐ Resolution of the executive committee approving the NGOAB application
- ☐ List of current executive committee members with designations

[VERIFY FULL CURRENT DOCUMENT LIST WITH NGOAB DIRECTLY] *The document requirements for NGOAB registration are subject to change. The above list represents commonly required items based on publicly available information but may not be complete or current. Obtain the official checklist from NGOAB before preparing the application.*

4.3 Critical Post-Registration Compliance Requirements (NGOAB)

Once NGOAB registration is obtained, the following obligations apply. **Non-compliance can result in suspension or cancellation of registration:**

- ☐ **Separate bank account for foreign funds** — Foreign donations must be received into and disbursed from a designated bank account. Foreign funds cannot be commingled with domestic funds.
- ☐ **Project-level approval before receiving foreign funds** — Each project funded by foreign donations requires a separate NGOAB approval before funds can be received. Registration alone does not authorize receipt of any specific foreign grant.
- ☐ **Annual report submission to NGOAB** — Submit an annual activity report and financial report to NGOAB by the required deadline each year [VERIFY CURRENT DEADLINE]
- ☐ **Project completion reports** — Submit project-specific completion reports to NGOAB upon conclusion of each approved project
- ☐ **Audit requirement** — Annual accounts must be audited by a qualified chartered accountant; audit report submitted to NGOAB as required
- ☐ **Retention of records** — Maintain financial records and project documents for the period specified by NGOAB regulations [VERIFY CURRENT RETENTION PERIOD]

4.4 Part B Completion Checklist

- ☐ Society registration complete (Part A done)
- ☐ Organizational bank account open (Section 5 done)
- ☐ TIN obtained (Section 6 done)
- ☐ NGOAB portal account created
- ☐ Project proposal prepared and reviewed

- ☐ 3-year budget prepared and reviewed by accountant
- ☐ All NGOAB documents compiled and verified
- ☐ Application submitted via NGOAB portal
- ☐ Submission reference number recorded and filed
- ☐ Registered office inspection completed
- ☐ Ministerial clearance obtained
- ☐ NGOAB Registration Certificate received
- ☐ Certified copies of NGOAB certificate obtained

5. Bank Account Requirements

5.1 When to Open the Account

- Open the organizational bank account immediately after receiving the Society Registration Certificate
- A bank account is required before NGOAB application can be submitted (if applicable)
- Do not use any personal bank account for organizational receipts or payments at any stage

5.2 Account Type and Bank Selection

- ☐ **Open a dedicated organizational bank account** in the name of Blu Foundation
- **Recommended bank options:**
 - Nationalized banks (Sonali Bank, Janata Bank, Agrani Bank, Rupali Bank) — widely recognized by government authorities and typically required for some government grant programs
 - Reputable private commercial banks — may offer more modern banking services and be preferred by some international funders
 - [VERIFY WITH NGOAB whether a specific type of bank is required for the foreign fund account]
- A **separate account for foreign donations** is mandatory if NGOAB registration is sought — this account may need to be at a scheduled bank with Bangladesh Bank approval for foreign exchange transactions [VERIFY WITH BANGLADESH BANK]

5.3 Documents Required to Open the Account

- ☐ Society Registration Certificate (certified copy)
- ☐ Memorandum of Association (certified copy)
- ☐ Rules and Regulations / Constitution (certified copy)
- ☐ Board/Executive Committee resolution authorizing the account opening and designating authorized signatories
- ☐ NID copies of all authorized signatories
- ☐ Passport-size photographs of authorized signatories

- ☐ Tax Identification Number (TIN) certificate (obtain TIN first — see Section 6)
- ☐ Proof of registered office address

[VERIFY WITH YOUR CHOSEN BANK] Each bank has its own account opening requirements for non-profit organizations. Request the bank's current document checklist before preparing documents.

5.4 Signatories and Authorization

- ☐ Designate at least two authorized signatories for the organizational account
- ☐ Determine whether joint signatures (two-to-sign) will be required for transactions above a threshold — recommended for good governance
- ☐ Record the signatory authorization in a formal board/executive committee resolution

5.5 Bank Account Section Checklist

- ☐ Bank selected
- ☐ Board resolution prepared authorizing account opening and designating signatories
- ☐ All required documents compiled per bank's checklist
- ☐ Account opened in the name of Blu Foundation
- ☐ Account number and bank details recorded in organizational records
- ☐ Online banking access established
- ☐ (If NGOAB registration sought) Separate foreign donations account opened or planned

6. Tax Registration

6.1 Tax Identification Number (TIN)

- ☐ **Apply for a Tax Identification Number (TIN)** from the National Board of Revenue (NBR)
 - TIN registration can be completed online via the NBR e-TIN portal [VERIFY CURRENT PORTAL URL WITH NBR]
 - Required for: NGOAB application, bank account opening, all tax filings
 - TIN is issued to the organization as an entity, not to an individual officer
- **Documents typically required for TIN registration:**
 - ☐ Society Registration Certificate
 - ☐ Memorandum of Association
 - ☐ NID of the authorized representative (typically the chairman or secretary)
 - ☐ Proof of registered office address

- [VERIFY CURRENT REQUIREMENTS WITH NBR OR ON THE E-TIN PORTAL]

6.2 Income Tax Exemption

- ☐ **Assess eligibility for income tax exemption** — Non-profit organizations engaged in charitable activities (including education) may qualify for exemption from income tax on income derived from charitable activities under the Income Tax Act (or applicable legislation at the time of filing)
 - [VERIFY CURRENT TAX EXEMPTION CRITERIA FOR EDUCATION NGOS WITH NBR OR A CHARTERED ACCOUNTANT]
 - Tax exemption is not automatic — an application for exemption or recognition as a charitable organization may be required
 - Exemption typically applies to charitable income, not to all income (e.g., commercially generated income may still be taxable)
- ☐ **If eligible, apply for income tax exemption** — Obtain the applicable form and process from NBR [VERIFY]

6.3 Annual Tax Compliance

Even if Blu Foundation qualifies for and obtains tax exemption, the following tax filing obligations apply:

- ☐ **Annual income tax return filing** — Required even if the organization has nil taxable income or is fully exempt
 - Filing deadline: [VERIFY CURRENT FILING DEADLINE WITH NBR]
 - Failure to file is an offense regardless of tax liability
- ☐ **Withholding tax obligations** — Blu Foundation, as an employer and as an organization making certain payments (e.g., to contractors), may be required to withhold tax at source and deposit it to NBR
 - [VERIFY CURRENT WITHHOLDING TAX OBLIGATIONS FOR NGOS WITH A CHARTERED ACCOUNTANT]

6.4 Tax Section Checklist

- ☐ TIN application submitted via NBR e-TIN portal
- ☐ TIN certificate received and stored
- ☐ Eligibility for income tax exemption assessed with a chartered accountant
- ☐ Income tax exemption application submitted (if applicable)
- ☐ Annual tax return filing system established (accountant engaged)
- ☐ Withholding tax obligations identified and compliance system in place

7. Post-Registration Compliance Calendar

The following recurring obligations arise after registration is complete. Failure to meet these obligations can result in penalties, suspension of registration, or cancellation.

[VERIFY ALL DEADLINES AND REQUIREMENTS CURRENT AS OF THE DATE OF OPERATION WITH RJSC, NGOAB, AND NBR]

Deadline	Task	Authority	Notes
Within 15 days of formation	Hold inaugural general meeting	Internal / RJSC	Elect executive committee, adopt rules
Quarterly (minimum)	Executive committee meeting	Internal	Maintain meeting minutes
Annually	Annual General Meeting (AGM)	Internal / RJSC	Required by Society rules; all members eligible to attend
Annually	Annual report and audited accounts submission to RJSC	RJSC	[VERIFY CURRENT DEADLINE AND FORMAT]
Annually	Annual report and audited accounts submission to NGOAB	NGOAB	Required only if NGOAB-registered; [VERIFY CURRENT DEADLINE]
Annually	Income tax return filing	NBR	Due by statutory deadline even if nil return; [VERIFY CURRENT DEADLINE]
Per project	Project approval application before receiving foreign funds	NGOAB	Required for each foreign-funded project; allow lead time
Per project	Project completion report	NGOAB	Required on conclusion of each approved foreign-funded project
Per NGOAB requirement	Audited financial statements	NBR / NGOAB	Prepared by a qualified chartered accountant
As required	Renewal of NGOAB registration	NGOAB	[VERIFY CURRENT RENEWAL PERIOD AND PROCESS WITH NGOAB]
As required	Update RJSC of changes to office bearers, address, or constitution	RJSC	Any material changes must be filed; [VERIFY PROCESS]
As required	Compliance with Bangladesh Bank reporting	Bangladesh Bank	Applicable to foreign currency transactions; [VERIFY REQUIREMENTS]

Recommended internal governance cadence:

- Board/executive committee meetings: at least once per quarter
- Financial review by committee: monthly
- Engagement with chartered accountant for compliance: ongoing

8. Estimated Timeline for Full Registration

The following is an approximate timeline from the point at which all preparatory decisions have been made (founders identified, address secured, legal counsel engaged).

Phase	Activity	Estimated Duration
Phase 1	Document preparation (constitution drafting, founding member docs, legal review)	2–4 weeks
Phase 2	Society registration (RJSC submission through receipt of certificate)	4–8 weeks
Phase 3	Organizational bank account opening	1–2 weeks
Phase 4	TIN registration (NBR e-TIN portal)	1–2 weeks
Phase 5	NGOAB application preparation (project proposal, budget, document compilation)	2–4 weeks
Phase 6	NGOAB application processing (submission through receipt of certificate)	3–6 months
Total	Start of preparation through full NGOAB registration	Approximately 6–9 months

Important notes on timeline:

- Phase 6 (NGOAB processing) is the most variable and time-consuming phase. Processing times depend on NGOAB workload, completeness of the application, ministry clearance timelines, and whether any additional information is requested. [VERIFY CURRENT AVERAGE PROCESSING TIME WITH NGOAB]
- Phases 3, 4, and 5 can be run in parallel with Phase 2 only to a limited extent. Society registration certificate is needed for bank account and TIN; TIN is needed for NGOAB; bank account is needed for NGOAB. Sequencing matters — see the dependency notes in each section.
- Delays in obtaining or submitting any document will extend the overall timeline. Complete preparation (Phase 1) before beginning Phase 2.
- Budget conservatively: a 9–12 month timeline from decision to full registration is realistic for first-time NGO founders.

9. Estimated Costs

All cost estimates below are approximations and subject to change. [VERIFY ALL OFFICIAL FEES DIRECTLY WITH THE RELEVANT AUTHORITY BEFORE BUDGETING.] Do not rely on these figures for final financial planning.

Cost Item	Estimated Amount	Notes
Society registration fee (RJSC)	[VERIFY CURRENT FEE WITH RJSC]	Government-set fee schedule; confirm directly with RJSC

Legal fees — constitution drafting and review	BDT 20,000–50,000 (estimate)	Varies by lawyer seniority and scope of work; get quotes from multiple lawyers
Notarization and attestation costs	[VERIFY]	Required for certain documents; actual cost depends on number of documents and notary fees
NGOAB application fee	[VERIFY CURRENT FEE WITH NGOAB]	Government-set fee; confirm directly with NGOAB
TIN registration	Nil (typically no fee for e-TIN registration)	[VERIFY NO FEE IS CURRENTLY APPLICABLE]
Bank account opening	Typically nil or minimal	Confirm with chosen bank; minimum deposit may be required
Chartered accountant — compliance (annual)	BDT 30,000–80,000/year (estimate)	Covers annual tax return, financial statements, RJSC/NGOAB report preparation; varies by firm and scope
Audit fees (annual, once operational)	BDT 30,000–80,000/year (estimate)	Required for NGOAB compliance; varies by size of organization and audit firm
Miscellaneous (printing, photocopying, courier, travel)	BDT 5,000–15,000 (estimate)	For document preparation and submission
Contingency	20–30% of total estimated budget	Allow for unexpected requirements, additional document costs, or professional fees

Strong recommendation: Engage a chartered accountant to develop a detailed formation budget based on current fees and the specific scope of work for Blu Foundation. The estimates above are indicative only.

10. Recommended Professional Support

Blu Foundation should engage the following professionals before taking any formal registration steps. This checklist is a guide, not a substitute for qualified professional advice.

10.1 Legal Counsel

- ☐ Engage a **lawyer qualified in Bangladesh law** with specific experience in:
 - Society registration under the Societies Registration Act 1860
 - NGO/NGOAB registration under the Foreign Donations (Voluntary Activities) Regulation Act 2016
 - Non-profit governance and compliance
- What the lawyer should do:**
 - Draft the Memorandum of Association and Rules and Regulations
 - Advise on the most appropriate registration pathway for Blu Foundation's specific circumstances
 - Review all documents before filing
 - Advise on ongoing legal compliance obligations

- [If applicable] Advise on any special requirements relating to foreign national founders or directors

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] *Has legal counsel been identified and engaged? If not, this is the highest-priority action item before any other step in this checklist.*

10.2 Chartered Accountant

- ☐ Engage a **qualified chartered accountant (CA)** with experience in NGO/non-profit accounting and compliance in Bangladesh. The CA should:
 - Advise on the TIN registration process
 - Prepare or review the 3-year budget for the NGOAB application
 - Establish a financial management system for the organization
 - Advise on tax exemption eligibility and application
 - Handle annual tax return filing
 - Provide or arrange annual audit services (required for NGOAB compliance)
 - Advise on withholding tax and other tax obligations

10.3 General Advisory Note

Blu Foundation should NOT rely solely on this document — or any single document — to guide its registration process. *NGO registration in Bangladesh involves government processes that change over time. Qualified professionals who are currently active in this area will have the most accurate and up-to-date information. Engage them early.*

11. Contact References

IMPORTANT: *Government website URLs, office addresses, phone numbers, and email contacts for Bangladeshi government agencies are subject to frequent change. The entries below provide the name of the authority and the type of contact to seek. **All contact details must be verified directly before use.** Do not rely on contact details found in third-party documents, blogs, or guides.*

Authority	Role in Registration	How to Find Current Contact
RJSC (Registrar of Joint Stock Companies and Firms)	Society registration (Part A)	Visit the official RJSC website; search for current office address and contact [CHECK CURRENT CONTACT ON RJSC WEBSITE]
NGOAB (NGO Affairs Bureau, Prime Minister's	NGOAB registration (Part B); foreign donation approvals	Visit the official NGOAB website for current contact and portal link [CHECK CURRENT CONTACT ON NGOAB

Office)		WEBSITE]
NBR (National Board of Revenue)	TIN registration; tax exemption; annual tax filing	Visit the official NBR website; use the NBR e-TIN portal for TIN registration [CHECK CURRENT CONTACT ON NBR WEBSITE]
Bangladesh Bank	Approval for foreign exchange accounts; foreign currency transaction reporting	Visit the official Bangladesh Bank website [CHECK CURRENT GUIDELINES ON BANGLADESH BANK WEBSITE]
Ministry of Social Welfare (or relevant line ministry)	Ministerial clearance for NGOAB registration	[VERIFY WHICH MINISTRY IS RELEVANT FOR EDUCATION NGOS AT TIME OF APPLICATION]

Recommended approach: Have legal counsel obtain and verify current contact details as part of their engagement. Experienced NGO lawyers maintain current working relationships with relevant government offices.

12. Important Disclaimer

This checklist is a general guide based on publicly available information about Bangladesh NGO registration requirements. It was prepared in June 2026 as Deliverable D14 for Blu Foundation.

This document:

- Does NOT constitute legal advice
- Does NOT constitute accounting or tax advice
- May NOT reflect the most current requirements, as regulations, fees, and procedures are subject to change
- Has NOT been reviewed or approved by any Bangladesh government authority
- Does NOT substitute for engagement with qualified professionals

Before taking any action based on this document, Blu Foundation must:

1. Consult a qualified Bangladeshi lawyer experienced in NGO registration law
2. Verify all specific requirements (fees, document lists, timelines, deadlines) directly with the relevant government authority (RJSC, NGOAB, NBR)
3. Confirm that no changes to the relevant legislation, regulations, or administrative procedures have occurred since this document was produced
4. Engage a chartered accountant for all tax and financial compliance matters

Reliance on this document without independent professional verification is at the sole risk of Blu Foundation and its founders.

13. Open Flags Summary

The following items require resolution before the registration process can advance. This summary is provided for tracking purposes.

Founder Input Required

Flag	Status	Owner
Will Blu Foundation seek foreign donations? (determines if NGOAB registration is required)	OPEN	Founder
Is the founding principal a Bangladeshi citizen? (affects approval requirements)	OPEN	Founder
Names and NID details of all founding board members (minimum 7)	OPEN	Founder
Registered office address	OPEN	Founder
Has legal counsel been identified and engaged?	OPEN	Founder

Verification Required (with Government Authorities)

Item	Authority	Status
Current Society registration fee	RJSC	UNVERIFIED
Current RJSC processing timeline	RJSC	UNVERIFIED
Current RJSC document checklist and copy/attestation requirements	RJSC	UNVERIFIED
Name availability search process	RJSC	UNVERIFIED
Full current NGOAB document checklist	NGOAB	UNVERIFIED
Current NGOAB processing timeline	NGOAB	UNVERIFIED
Current NGOAB registration fee	NGOAB	UNVERIFIED
NGOAB renewal period and process	NGOAB	UNVERIFIED
Relevant line ministry for education NGO clearance	NGOAB	UNVERIFIED
Current TIN registration process and fee (if any)	NBR	UNVERIFIED
Income tax exemption eligibility criteria for education NGOs	NBR	UNVERIFIED
Annual tax return filing deadline	NBR	UNVERIFIED
Bangladesh Bank requirements for foreign fund bank accounts	Bangladesh Bank	UNVERIFIED

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